

JUNE NEWSLETTER

14 JUNE 2022



Dear Families,

It is hard to believe that we are nearly halfway through the year all ready. Last month was busy for the staff as we faced changes in the service from the bathroom & ceiling renovations to changes in staffing. The commitment by the current staff to the service and high-quality education & care meant that the children seemed not to notice to much disruption to their days of learning and social engagement.

Many of the Mum's and staff met for a night out at the Avon Valley Inn. This was a great opportunity for meeting new people and strengthening social links. Thanks to Chontelle our Vice President and other committee members for organizing this event.



USING THE XPLOR APP

The Xplor app is an important communication link between families and your child's classroom educators. Digital signing in and out is a legal part of the funding agreement between the NSW State and Federal Governments.

All children must legally be signed in and out by the person who drops off and picks up the child. Please assist us by ensuring you have your app or your personal login code to fulfill this requirement.

Please check and respond to messages sent via the app regarding your child's day or activities and events that are occurring in your child's classroom. A high-quality service requires consistency of two-way communication between families and educators. Often educators will be requesting information or photos that are used within the program. Child feel disappointed when they don't have their photo to include in the current classroom discussion or activity.

Other important messages such as the recent power outage and possible service closure are also sent through the app. We noticed only 20% of families read this message.

EASING OF COVID RESTRICTIONS –

ACCESS TO THE SERVICE

From Tuesday the 14th of June we will be easing-in some of the COVID restrictions that have been in place now for over two years. In the afternoons, one adult will be allowed into the service to pick up their child, view activities children have been engaged with in the classrooms and documentation from educators.

We would just like to remind families that there is still a high rate of COVID circulating within the community so if you have any signs or symptoms please remain outside the service and a staff member will bring your child out to you.

PLAYGROUP DATES

Booral...Tues 14 Jun
Coolongolook...Wed 15 Jun
Gloucester CWA...Tues 21 Jun
Booral...Tues 28 Jun
Gloucester CWA...Tues 19 Jul
Coolongolook...Wed 20 Jul
Booral...Tues 26 July
Gloucester CWA...Tues 2 Aug
Coolongolook...Wed 3 Aug
Booral...Tues 8 Aug

DATES TO REMEMBER

- **Committee Meeting—**
Tuesday 28th June at 6pm

EQUIPMENT PURCHASES

Scissors, paint brushes, baby/toddler large soft foam block indoor tunnel maze climber playset

VACATION CARE BOOKINGS

The Vacation Care booking form will be sent out shortly. Please ensure that all preschool children requiring a vacation care position is booked in by 22/06/2022. The service is staffed for the number of booked places and late bookings cannot always be accommodated due to staffing ratios.

POLICIES REVIEW IN MAY

- Reimbursement Policy
- Photography Policy
- Lock Up Policy
- Lockdown Policy

RENOVATIONS IN THE DAPIN ROOM

We're pleased to say that the renovations to the Dapin Room are nearly complete. The ceiling has been replaced after the water damage at the end of last year and the whole classroom has had a fresh coat of paint.

The children resumed classroom activities on Monday the 6th of June.

The bathroom renovations should be completed by the start of July. Dapin children will be using the Gawul Room's bathroom until the work is completed.

STAFFING CHANGES

The service was sad to receive Barney's resignation at the start of this term. She has worked for the service for seven years and during that time built strong relationships with families and children. We wish her all the best for her future and new professional work opportunities.

Sharon has now taken on the role of Room Leader in the Dapin Room, supported by Rashelle and Olivia. Sharon has been working in many roles within the service this year and comes with many years of experience working in services in Sydney.

SUPPORTING ONGOING PROFESSIONAL GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT

The service has a long-term commitment to supporting the professional development of educators. This strategic strategy gives locals the opportunity to develop a career in the Early Childhood Education & Care and support the employment of high quality and well-trained educators to work in our service.

We are delighted that Rashelle has agreed to start her Diploma in Early Childhood Education & Care extending on her current skills and knowledge gained from her Certificate III. It will take her between 18 months & two years to complete her Diploma.

EMERGENCY DRILLS

As part of our regulation requirements the service must complete emergency drills each term. These emergency drills occur every day across the week ensuring that every child has the opportunity to be involved and discuss safety actions within an emergency.

Some of the children have been involved in making decisions about what emergency drill we would practice and what are the best options to support the safety of all the children and staff.

This is a good time to have discussions at home about what you may do in emergencies such as safe meeting points and for older children learning their home address.



80% OFF COMPOST BINS & WORM FARMS FROM MIDCOAST COUNCIL

It is great to see MidCoast Council joining Compost Revolution, war on waste program. They are now offering residents up to 80% off RRP and FREE delivery on worm farms, bokashi and compost bins. All the children in the service are involved in feeding our worm farm so they are already knowledgeable and can support your home composting project. Follow the link on the Midcoast councils web site. <https://compostrevolution.com.au/midcoast/>

Let us know if you purchase one and share some pictures of your child composting at home.



TRIAL OF ECO DISPOSABLE NAPPIES

Supporting our sustainability program, we have been exploring the many options of reducing our waste. One of the largest wastes from the service is un-compostable nappies. Dom has been investigating a range of more ecofriendly nappy options and we are now about to start a trial.

All about nappies:

What's in a nappy?

- Plastic components make up over 70% of a majority single-use nappies in Australia, which equates to 10g of plastic in just one single-use nappy. That's one plastic bottle in each nappy.
- Colourful nappies are created using dyes and inks, none of which are desirable next to baby's skin.
- Conditioners are often used to soften nappies for comfort, bleaches are used to neutralise colours, fragrances added to hide chemical smells and toxins are found throughout many disposable nappies to aid absorbency.
- Incredibly there can be up to 1 cup of crude oil used per disposable nappy and up to 50 different chemicals in all plus all the plastic. Not only are these factors the main contributor to nappy rash and irritated skin, they cannot biodegrade once used.

Eco Nappies

- Only pure cotton, sustainably sourced wood-pulp and non-GMO cornstarch against your baby's skin.
- No phthalates. No fragrances. No dioxins. No bleach. No lotions.
- Non-toxic and nothing harmful or irritating to delicate skin.

Watch this short video of a toddler talking about nappies. <https://www.ecor originals.com.au/pages/whats-in-a-babys-nappy>

Please give us your feedback when we start this trail.

Please Recycle your printer Ink Cartridges.
There is a drop-off point at the
Gloucester Visitor Information Centre.

Please Recycle your clean soft plastics.
There is a drop-off point at Woolworths.
For more information, see the Redcycle
Website: <https://redcycle.net.au>



BANGGU ROOM NEWS

The children in the Banggu room have shown a great deal of interest in animals and the sounds they make. We have been exploring this interest using technology, music, books, puzzles and creating a farm table within the room. The children have enjoyed sharing their knowledge of the different animal sounds they know and share their enthusiasm and curiosity in learning new information. We would love if you could share with us any animal experiences your children are engaged with at home or any photographs of your children's pets so we can include them into our program, we can't wait see them.

From the Banggu team—Kayla, Tyler, Kareen and Dom



YAPII ROOM NEWS

During the term the Yapii Room have been discovering some amazing creatures within our outdoor learning environment. The children have been contributing to our garden project book where we have investigated and been monitoring the life cycle of tadpoles in our classroom, getting up close to our blue tongue lizards, exploring the different birds we observe in our environment and caring for the Peron's Tree frog that is living in our gardens.

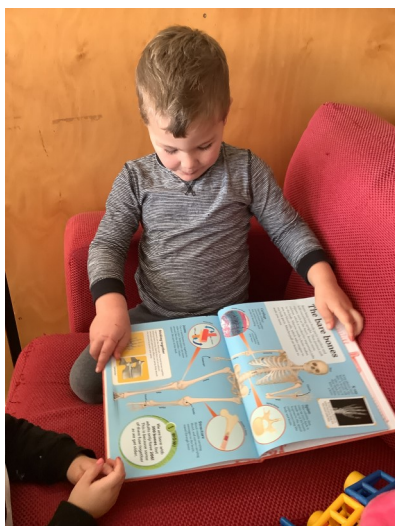
From the Yapii team Kathryn and Lucy



GAWUL ROOM NEWS

The Gawul children have been investigating different ways to stay healthy during this winter season through learning about the parts of the human body and how we can take care of it. We linked this with their interest in Rainbows as we explored and tasted different healthy fruit and vegetables with the colours of the rainbow. They have also been interested in magic. They liked being magicians and learning about all the magic in our world, such as how plants and trees grow and provide us with healthy fruit and vegetables to nourish us.

From the Gawul team—Sharon, Rashelle and Olivia



DAPIN ROOM NEWS

This month in the Dapin class we have had a month of outdoor adventures and explorations! We have explored the changes of the environment as we watch the onset of winter during several walking excursions around Gloucester. Part of our excursions was to collect natural items that we could use at preschool in our art, craft and as creative provocations also resources to incorporate into sandpit play and mud cooking creations.

We have welcomed new children to our classroom this month and everyone has settled in confidently.

Having an outdoor classroom has allowed the children to be challenged with STEM challenges on a huge scale. One challenge was to construct a shelter that was big enough for their working group of peers to all fit inside. This experience also promoted small group collaboration, problem solving and turn taking.

Our project 'Caring for others' has continued with our emphasis on ways that we can help others without expecting anything in return. This month we have turned our learning to showing care and empathy for people in the Gloucester community that we may have never met. We have engaged in a program that we have called 'Adopt a neighbourhood' where the children have discussed what we should put in a care package that we can post into letterboxes around our preschool neighbourhood. The children have designed their own drawings, Jack, Jed and Jenny have recorded each child's message on the back of the drawing. The only instruction for the drawings was to represent things that make them happy and things they believe would make other people that they don't know feel happy as well. These packages will go into letter boxes during walking excursions over the next two weeks.

We will soon be holding a baby name guessing experience. Could all Dapin room families please bring in a photo of your child as a baby. We would like to have all photos supplied so that the other children don't see them before they are displayed. We would appreciate the photos as soon as possible please, they can be emailed to staff@gloucesterpreschool.com.au or can come in with your child in hard copy.

From the Dapin team: Jenny, Jacklyn and Jed



Child Care Subsidy update for Long Day Care Families

Balancing: 30 June deadline for families

The end of financial year marks two important deadlines for families:

- the first deadline for confirming 2020–21 income
- the second deadline for confirming 2019–20 income.

Families must take action by 30 June to avoid losing CCS or incurring a debt.

2019–20 financial year

Most families confirmed their 2019–20 income before the first deadline on 30 June 2021.

Families who haven't confirmed their 2019–20 income must do so by 30 June 2022.

If they don't, they may need to pay back all the CCS they got for 2019–20.

More information about debts is available on [Services Australia's website](#).

They will also lose their CCS and Additional Child Care Subsidy (ACCS) eligibility from the first CCS fortnight of the 2022–23 financial year.

You will need to direct these families to make a new claim if they wish to get a reduced fee again.

Families can only claim CCS again once they have:

- confirmed their income, and
- repaid any current or previous child care related debt, or

entered into a repayment arrangement.

Families who miss the second deadline will also miss out on any top up of CCS for which they may have been eligible.

2020–21 financial year

All families must confirm their 2020–21 income before the first deadline on 30 June 2022.

If they don't, their CCS will stop. This means they'll need to pay full fees when they use child care.

Services Australia can start a family's CCS again, but only after they've confirmed their income. This means families may miss out on CCS.

How to confirm income

Families confirm their income by:

- lodging their tax return, or

telling Services Australia they don't need to lodge a tax return. Families can complete an [Advise non-lodgement of tax return](#) using their [Centrelink online account](#) through [myGov](#) or through the [Express Plus Centrelink mobile app](#). They'll need to do this even if they've already told the Australian Taxation Office they don't need to lodge.

If a parent separates from their partner, Services Australia will also need their ex-partner's income.

If a parent is concerned that their ex-partner won't lodge their tax return by the deadline they should call the [Families line](#).

Action needed

Please confirm your income before the deadline. If you have any questions, please go to the Services Australia

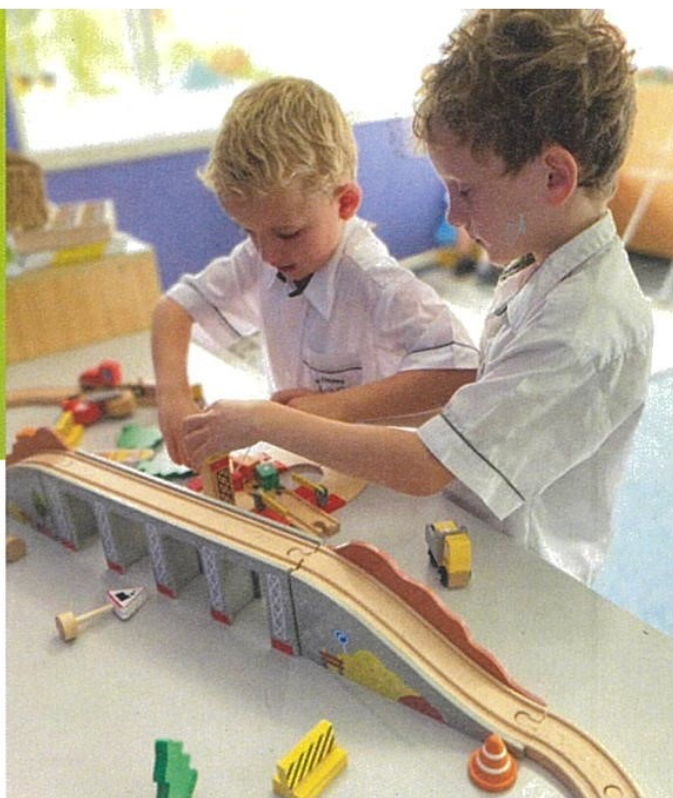
Successful Foundations for Learning

In 2022, St Joseph's Gloucester launched the 'Successful Foundations for Learning' project to support the positive transition of Kindergarten students.

Early Learning experts, Bridie Stanger and Taylor Stokes will be at St Joseph's Gloucester on Wednesday June 15th to share their expertise on Successful Foundations for Learning. Mrs Kylie Clare, Kindergarten teacher will provide insights on Successful Foundations in the Kindergarten classroom.

Successful Foundations provides children with the opportunity to actively demonstrate their knowledge, build relationships and become familiar with the context of the school, through PLAY!

Successful Foundations provides teachers with the opportunity to become familiar with children and families as they develop deep and meaningful relationships through their observations and interactions with the competent, creative and capable child.



Successful Foundations assists teachers to get to know their children by implementing play opportunities in the first weeks of kindergarten. In particular, it assists kindergarten teachers to:

- ▶ observe, listen to, document and analyse children's learning, skills and knowledge
- ▶ facilitate conversations with children, families and colleagues
- ▶ profile children's strengths, interests and learning needs.

Wednesday 15 June 10am

ST JOSEPH'S PRIMARY SCHOOL 53 DENISON ST, GLOUCESTER

For more information, contact St Joseph's – 02 6558 1555

Enrol now for Kindergarten 2023



mn.catholic.edu.au